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Chip stack structure with conductive plug and method for forming the same

Abstract

A chip stack structure is provided. The chip stack structure includes a first chip including a first substrate and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate. The chip stack structure includes a second chip over and bonded to the first chip. The second chip has a second interconnect structure and a second substrate over the second interconnect structure. The chip stack structure includes an insulating layer over the second interconnect structure and surrounding the second substrate. The chip stack structure includes a conductive plug penetrating through the insulating layer to the second interconnect structure.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY CLAIM AND CROSS-REFERENCE (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/433,261, filed on Dec. 16, 2022, and entitled “CHIP STACK STRUCTURE WITH CONDUCTIVE PLUG AND METHOD FOR FORMING THE SAME”, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND

(1) The semiconductor industry has experienced rapid growth due to continuous improvements in the integration density of a variety of electronic components (e.g., transistors, diodes, resistors, capacitors, etc.). For the most part, this improvement in integration density has come from repeated reductions in minimum feature size (e.g., shrinking the semiconductor process node towards the sub-20 nm node), which allows more components to be integrated into a given area. As the demand for miniaturization, higher speed and greater bandwidth, as well as lower power consumption and latency has grown recently, there has grown a need for smaller and more creative packaging techniques of semiconductor dies.

(2) As semiconductor technologies further advance, stacked semiconductor devices, e.g., 3D integrated circuits (3DIC), have emerged as an effective alternative to further reduce the physical size of a semiconductor device. In a stacked semiconductor device, active circuits such as logic, memory, processor circuits and the like are fabricated on different semiconductor wafers. Two or more semiconductor wafers may be installed on top of one another to further reduce the form factor of the semiconductor device.

(3) Two semiconductor wafers or dies may be bonded together through suitable bonding techniques. An electrical connection may be provided between the stacked semiconductor wafers. The stacked semiconductor devices may provide a higher density with smaller form factors and allow for increased performance and lower power consumption.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It should be noted that, in accordance with standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

(2) FIGS. 1A-1G are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(3) FIG. 1C-1 is a top view of the semiconductor structures of FIG. 1C, in accordance with some

embodiments.

(4) FIG. 1D-1 is a top view of the semiconductor structures and the insulating layer of FIG. 1D, in accordance with some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 1E-1 is a top view of the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, and the conductive plugs of FIG. 1E, in accordance with some embodiments.

(6) FIG. 1F-1 is a top view of the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, the conductive plugs, and the conductive bumps of FIG. 1F, in accordance with some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(8) FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(9) FIG. 4 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(10) FIGS. 5A-5B are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(11) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(12) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(13) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(14) FIGS. 9A-9B are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(15) FIG. 10 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(16) FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(17) FIG. 12 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(18) FIGS. 13A-13B are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(19) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(20) FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(21) FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(22) FIGS. 17A-17D are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(23) FIG. 18 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(24) FIG. 19 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(25) FIG. 20 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(26) FIGS. 21A-21D are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(27) FIG. 22 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(28) FIG. 23 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some

embodiments.

(29) FIG. 24 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(30) FIGS. 25A-25E are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(31) FIG. 26 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(32) FIG. 27 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(33) FIG. 28 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(34) FIG. 29 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(35) FIG. 30 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(36) FIG. 31 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

(37) FIG. 32 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(38) The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the subject matter provided. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

(39) Furthermore, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature's relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

(40) Some embodiments of the disclosure are described. Additional operations can be provided before, during, and/or after the stages described in these embodiments. Some of the stages that are described can be replaced or eliminated for different embodiments. Additional features can be added to the semiconductor device structure. Some of the features described below can be replaced or eliminated for different embodiments. Although some embodiments are discussed with operations performed in a particular order, these operations may be performed in another logical order.

(41) Other features and processes may also be included. For example, testing structures may be included to aid in the verification testing of the 3D packaging or 3DIC devices. The testing structures may include, for example, test pads formed in a redistribution layer or on a substrate that allows the testing of the 3D packaging or 3DIC, the use of probes and/or probe cards, and the like. The verification testing may be performed on intermediate structures as well as the final structure.

Additionally, the structures and methods disclosed herein may be used in conjunction with testing methodologies that incorporate intermediate verification of known good dies to increase the yield and decrease costs.

(42) FIGS. 1A-1G are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 1A, a semiconductor structure **110** is provided, in accordance with some embodiments. The semiconductor structure **110** includes a substrate structure **112'**, a device layer **114**, and an interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The device layer **114** is formed over the substrate structure **112'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnect structure **116** is formed over the device layer **114**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(43) The substrate structure **112'** includes, for example, a semiconductor substrate. The substrate structure **112'** includes, for example, a semiconductor wafer (such as a silicon wafer) or a portion of a semiconductor wafer. In some embodiments, the substrate structure **112'** is made of an elementary semiconductor material including silicon or germanium in a single crystal structure, a polycrystal structure, or an amorphous structure.

(44) In some other embodiments, the substrate structure **112'** is made of a compound semiconductor, such as silicon carbide, gallium arsenide, gallium phosphide, indium phosphide, indium arsenide, an alloy semiconductor, such as SiGe or GaAsP, or a combination thereof. The substrate structure **112'** may also include multi-layer semiconductors, semiconductor on insulator (SOI) (such as silicon on insulator or germanium on insulator), or a combination thereof.

(45) In some embodiments, isolation features (not shown) are formed in the substrate structure **112'**. The isolation features are used to surround active regions and electrically isolate various device elements formed in and/or over the substrate structure **112'** in the active regions. In some embodiments, the isolation features include shallow trench isolation (STI) features, local oxidation of silicon (LOCOS) features, other suitable isolation features, or a combination thereof.

(46) The device layer **114** includes device elements (not shown), conductive vias (not shown), and one or more wiring layers (not shown), in accordance with some embodiments. The device elements are formed over a surface **112a'** of the substrate structure **112'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias are over and connected to the device elements, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers are over the conductive vias, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias are connected between the one or more wiring layers and the device elements, in accordance with some embodiments.

(47) Examples of the device elements include active devices, passive devices, other suitable elements, or a combination thereof. The active devices may include transistors or diodes formed at the surface **112a'** of the substrate structure **112'**. The passive devices include resistors, capacitors, inductors, or other suitable passive devices.

(48) For example, the transistors may be metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistors (MOSFET), complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) transistors, bipolar junction transistors (BJT), high-voltage transistors, high-frequency transistors, p-channel and/or n-channel field effect transistors (PFETs/NFETs), etc. Various processes, such as front-end-of-line (FEOL) semiconductor fabrication processes, are performed to form the various device elements. The FEOL semiconductor fabrication processes may include deposition, etching, implantation, photolithography, annealing, planarization, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

(49) The wiring layers and the conductive vias are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(50) The interconnect structure **116** includes a dielectric layer **116a**, wiring layers **116b**, bonding pads **116p**, and conductive vias **116v**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **116b** and conductive vias **116v** are in the dielectric layer **116a**, in accordance with some

embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. 1A only shows two of the wiring layers **116b**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(51) The conductive vias **116v** are connected between the wiring layers **116b** and the wiring layer of the device layer **114**, in accordance with some embodiments. The bonding pads **116p** are embedded in the dielectric layer **116a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The bonding pads **116p** are over and connected to the top-most one of the wiring layers **116b**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(52) The dielectric layer **116a** is made of an oxide-containing material (e.g. silicon oxide, borosilicate glass (BSG), phosphoric silicate glass (PSG), borophosphosilicate glass (BPSG), or fluorinated silicate glass (FSG)), a nitrogen-containing material (e.g., silicon oxynitride), a low-k material, a porous dielectric material, or a combination thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(53) The wiring layers **116b**, the conductive vias **116v**, and the bonding pads **116p** are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(54) As shown in FIG. 1A, a semiconductor structure **120** is provided, in accordance with some embodiments. The semiconductor structure **120** includes a substrate structure **122'**, a device layer **124**, and an interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The device layer **124** is formed over the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnect structure **126** is formed over the device layer **124** and the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(55) The substrate structure **122'** includes, for example, a semiconductor substrate. The substrate structure **122'** includes, for example, a semiconductor wafer (such as a silicon wafer) or a portion of a semiconductor wafer.

(56) In some embodiments, the substrate structure **122'** is made of an elementary semiconductor material including silicon or germanium in a single crystal structure, a polycrystal structure, or an amorphous structure. In some other embodiments, the substrate structure **122'** is made of a compound semiconductor, such as silicon carbide, gallium arsenide, gallium phosphide, indium phosphide, indium arsenide, an alloy semiconductor, such as SiGe or GaAsP, or a combination thereof. The substrate structure **122'** may also include multi-layer semiconductors, semiconductor on insulator (SOI) (such as silicon on insulator or germanium on insulator), or a combination thereof.

(57) In some embodiments, isolation features (not shown) are formed in the substrate structure **122'**. The isolation features are used to surround active regions and electrically isolate various device elements formed in and/or over the substrate structure **122'** in the active regions. In some embodiments, the isolation features include shallow trench isolation (STI) features, local oxidation of silicon (LOCOS) features, other suitable isolation features, or a combination thereof.

(58) The device layer **124** includes device elements (not shown), conductive vias (not shown), and one or more wiring layers (not shown), in accordance with some embodiments. The device elements are formed over a surface **122a'** of the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias are connected to the device elements, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias are connected between the one or more wiring layers and the device elements, in accordance with some embodiments.

(59) Examples of the device elements include active devices, passive devices, other suitable elements, or a combination thereof. The active devices may include transistors or diodes formed at the surface **122a'** of the substrate structure **122'**. The passive devices include resistors, capacitors, inductors, or other suitable passive devices.

(60) For example, the transistors may be metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistors (MOSFET), complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) transistors, bipolar junction transistors (BJT), high-voltage transistors, high-frequency transistors, p-channel and/or n-channel

field effect transistors (PFETs/NFETs), etc. Various processes, such as front-end-of-line (FEOL) semiconductor fabrication processes, are performed to form the various device elements. The FEOL semiconductor fabrication processes may include deposition, etching, implantation, photolithography, annealing, planarization, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof. In some other embodiments, the device layer **124** only includes conductive vias and one or more wiring layers and does not include device elements.

(61) The wiring layers and the conductive vias are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(62) The interconnect structure **126** includes a dielectric layer **126a**, wiring layers **126b**, bonding pads **126p**, and conductive vias **126v**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **126b** and conductive vias **126v** are in the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. **1A** only shows two of the wiring layers **126b**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(63) The conductive vias **126v** are connected between the wiring layers **126b** and the wiring layer of the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments. The bonding pads **126p** are embedded in the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The bonding pads **126p** are connected to the wiring layer **126b**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(64) The dielectric layer **126a** is made of an oxide-containing material (e.g. silicon oxide, borosilicate glass (BSG), phosphoric silicate glass (PSG), borophosphosilicate glass (BPSG), or fluorinated silicate glass (FSG)), a nitrogen-containing material (e.g., silicon oxynitride), a low-k material, a porous dielectric material, or a combination thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(65) The wiring layers **126b**, the conductive vias **126v**, and the bonding pads **126p** are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(66) As shown in FIG. **1A**, the semiconductor structure **120** is flipped upside down and bonded to the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The bonding pads **126p** are bonded to the bonding pads **116p**, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer **126a** is bonded to the dielectric layer **116a**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(67) As shown in FIG. **1B**, a thinning process is performed on a surface **122b'** of the substrate structure **122'** to thin the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The thinning process includes a planarization process such as a chemical mechanical polishing process, in accordance with some embodiments. After the thinning process, the (minimum) thickness **T1** of the substrate structure **122'** is greater than or equal to about 1 μm , in accordance with some embodiments. If the thickness **T1** is less than 1 μm , the substrate structure **122'** may be too thin for the following etching process. The thickness **T1** ranges from about 1 μm to about 15 μm , in accordance with some embodiments.

(68) FIG. **1C-1** is a top view of the semiconductor structures of FIG. **1C**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **1C** is a cross-sectional view illustrating the semiconductor structures along a sectional line I-I' in FIG. **1C-1**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(69) As shown in FIGS. **1B**, **1C** and **1C-1**, portions of the semiconductor structure **120** are removed to form a trench **128** in the semiconductor structure **120**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** passes through the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(70) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrate structure **122'** and the interconnect structure **126** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the substrate structure **122'** and the interconnect structure **126**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the interconnect

structure **126**. The etching processes of the application can also stop at the target layer (or the target element) for the same reason.

(71) As shown in FIGS. **1C** and **1C-1**, portions of the substrate structure **122'** remain over the interconnect structure **126** after the removal process of the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The portions form substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** continuously surrounds the substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(72) As shown in FIG. **1C**, one of the substrates **122**, the device layer **124** under the one of the substrates **122**, and the interconnect structure **126** under the one of the substrates **122** together form a chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips C share the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnect structure **126** is wider than each substrate **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(73) FIG. **1D-1** is a top view of the semiconductor structures and the insulating layer of FIG. **1D**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **1D** is a cross-sectional view illustrating the semiconductor structures and the insulating layer along a sectional line I-I' in FIG. **1D-1**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(74) As shown in FIGS. **1D** and **1D-1**, an insulating layer **130** is formed in the trench **128**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** is over the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** continuously surrounds the substrates **122** and the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(75) The insulating layer **130** is made of an oxide-containing material (e.g. silicon oxide, borosilicate glass (BSG), phosphoric silicate glass (PSG), borophosphosilicate glass (BPSG), or fluorinated silicate glass (FSG)), a nitrogen-containing material (e.g., silicon oxynitride), a low-k material, a porous dielectric material, a polymer material, or a combination thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(76) The insulating layer **130** is formed using a deposition process or a spin-on process and a chemical mechanical polishing process, in accordance with some embodiments. The deposition process includes a chemical vapor deposition process, a high density plasma chemical vapor deposition process, a flowable chemical vapor deposition process, a sputtering process, or a combination thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(77) FIG. **1E-1** is a top view of the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, and the conductive plugs of FIG. **1E**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **1E** is a cross-sectional view illustrating the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, and the conductive plugs along a sectional line I-I' in FIG. **1E-1**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(78) As shown in FIGS. **1E** and **1E-1**, the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a** are partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH partially expose the bonding pads **116p** of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(79) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer **126a** and the bonding pads **116p** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the dielectric layer **126a** and the bonding pads **116p**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the bonding pads **116p**.

(80) As shown in FIGS. **1E** and **1E-1**, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a** to the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. The width W₁₄₀ of the conductive plug **140** decreases toward the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(81) The conductive plugs **140** are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** are formed using a deposition process (or a plating process) and a chemical mechanical polishing process, in accordance with some embodiments. The deposition process includes a physical vapor deposition process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(82) FIG. **1F-1** is a top view of the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, the conductive bumps, and the conductive plugs of FIG. **1F**, in accordance with some embodiments. FIG. **1F** is a cross-sectional view illustrating the semiconductor structures, the insulating layer, the conductive bumps, and the conductive plugs along a sectional line I-I' in FIG. **1F-1**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(83) As shown in FIGS. **1F** and **1F-1**, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **140**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **150** are made of a solder material including Tin (Sn) and alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments. In some other embodiments, the conductive bumps **150** are made of a metal material or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(84) As shown in FIGS. **1E**, **1F** and **1F-1**, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structures **110** and **120** and the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures **100** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. **1F** only shows one of the chip stack structures **100**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(85) Each chip stack structure **100** includes a chip **110a** and a chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** comes from the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** includes a substrate **112** which comes from the substrate structure **112'**, a portion of the device layer **114**, and a portion of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure **120a** includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer **130**, some of the conductive plugs **140**, and some of the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip C is thinner than the chip **110a**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(86) As shown in FIG. **1G**, the chip stack structure **100** is bonded to a substrate **160** through the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip stack structure **100** is electrically connected to the substrate **160** through the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(87) The substrate **160** includes a wiring substrate or an interposer substrate, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring substrate includes, for example, a dielectric structure, wiring layers in the dielectric structure, conductive vias in the dielectric structure and electrically connected between the wiring layers, in accordance with some embodiments.

(88) The interposer substrate includes, for example, a substrate, a first redistribution layer over the substrate and electrically connected to the conductive bumps **150**, a second redistribution layer under the substrate, and conductive vias passing through the substrate and electrically connected between the first redistribution layer and the second redistribution layer. In some other embodiments, the interposer substrate does not have the first redistribution layer and/or the second redistribution layer. In this step, a chip package structure **100P** is substantially formed, in accordance with some embodiments.

(89) The conductive plugs **140** are used to deliver signal and power between the chip stack structure **100** and the substrate **160**, in accordance with some embodiments. Since the conductive plugs **140** are directly connected to the interconnect structure **116** without through the interconnect structure **126**, the conductive path between the interconnect structure **116** and the substrate **160** is shortened, in accordance with some embodiments.

(90) Therefore, the resistance of the conductive path between the chip **110a** and the substrate **160** is decreased, in accordance with some embodiments. As a result, the signal integrity and the power

integrity between the chip **110a** and the substrate **160** are improved, in accordance with some embodiments.

(91) In some embodiments, the chip **110a** is a logic chip, and the chips **C** are memory chips such as a resistive random access memory (RRAM) chip, a dynamic random access memory (DRAM) chip, and/or a magnetic random access memory (MRAM) chip. Since the power integrity between the chip **110a** and the substrate **160** is improved, the stability of the operation of the (logic) chip **110a** is improved, in accordance with some embodiments. Therefore, the performance of the chip package structure **100P** is improved, in accordance with some embodiments.

(92) In some other embodiments, the conductive plugs **140** are directly connected to wiring layers of the interconnect structure **116** or **126** according to different requirements.

(93) Since the conductive plugs **140** do not pass through the device layer **124** of the chip **C**, the size (e.g., the average width **W140a**) of the conductive plugs **140** is not limited to the layout of the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments. Therefore, the conductive plugs **140** may have a greater width than conductive plugs (not shown) passing through a device layer of a chip. As a result, the resistance of the conductive path between the chip **110a** and the substrate **160** is decreased, in accordance with some embodiments. Therefore, the signal integrity and the power integrity between the chip **110a** and the substrate **160** are improved, in accordance with some embodiments.

(94) The average width **W140a** of the conductive plugs **140** ranges from about 4.5 μm to about 25 μm , in accordance with some embodiments. If the average width **W140a** is less than 4.5 μm , the resistance of the conductive plugs **140** may be too large. If the average width **W140a** is greater than 25 μm , the conductive plugs **140** may occupy too much space, which may limit the size of the chips **C**.

(95) FIG. 2 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **200**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 2, the chip stack structure **200** is similar to the chip stack structure **100** of FIG. 1F, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **200** has only one chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(96) FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **300**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 3, the chip stack structure **300** is similar to the chip stack structure **100** of FIG. 1F, except that the chip stack structure **300** further has a redistribution layer (RDL) **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(97) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(98) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(99) The dielectric layer **312** is made of a polymer material, an oxide-containing material (e.g. silicon oxide, borosilicate glass (BSG), phosphoric silicate glass (PSG), borophosphosilicate glass (BPSG), or fluorinated silicate glass (FSG)), a nitrogen-containing material (e.g., silicon oxynitride), a low-k material, a porous dielectric material, or a combination thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(100) The wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316** are made of conductive materials such as metal (e.g., aluminum, copper, gold, silver, tungsten or the like) or alloys thereof, in accordance

with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are made of a solder material including Tin (Sn) and alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments. In some other embodiments, the conductive bumps **320** are made of a metal material or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(101) FIG. **4** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **400**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **4**, the chip stack structure **400** is similar to the chip stack structure **300** of FIG. **3**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **400** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(102) FIGS. **5A-5B** are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **5A**, after the step of FIG. **1D**, the insulating layer **130** is partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(103) The interconnect structure **126** includes a wiring layer **126b'** embedded in the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. A surface S of the wiring layer **126b'** is exposed by the trench **128**, in accordance with some embodiments. The surface S of the wiring layer **126b'** is exposed by the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The surface S of the wiring layer **126b'** is substantially level with a surface **126al** of the dielectric layer **126a** under the substrate **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(104) The through holes TH partially expose the surface S of the wiring layer **126b'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(105) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** and the wiring layer **126b'** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the insulating layer **130** and the wiring layer **126b'**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the wiring layer **126b'**.

(106) As shown in FIG. **5A**, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** to the wiring layer **126b'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** are in direct contact with the surface S of the wiring layer **126b'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the substrates **122** and the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(107) As shown in FIG. **5B**, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **140**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **150** are made of a solder material including Tin (Sn) and alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments. In some other embodiments, the conductive bumps **150** are made of a metal material or alloys thereof, in accordance with some embodiments.

(108) As shown in FIGS. **5A** and **5B**, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structures **110** and **120** and the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures **500** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. **5B** only shows one of the chip stack structures **500**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(109) Each chip stack structure **500** includes a chip **110a** and a chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** comes from the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** includes a substrate **112** which comes from the substrate structure **112'**, a portion of the device layer **114**, and a portion of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure **120a** includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer **130**, some of the conductive plugs **140**, and some of the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(110) FIG. 6 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **600**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 6, the chip stack structure **600** is similar to the chip stack structure **500** of FIG. 5B, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **600** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(111) FIG. 7 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **700**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 7, the chip stack structure **700** is similar to the chip stack structure **500** of FIG. 5B, except that the chip stack structure **700** further has a redistribution layer (RDL) **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(112) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(113) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and C are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(114) FIG. 8 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **800**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 8, the chip stack structure **800** is similar to the chip stack structure **700** of FIG. 7, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **800** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(115) FIGS. 9A-9B are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 9A, after the step of FIG. 1D, the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a** are partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130** and extend into the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH partially expose the wiring layer **126b** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(116) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer **126a** and the wiring layer **126b** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the dielectric layer **126a** and the wiring layer **126b**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the wiring layer **126b**.

(117) As shown in FIG. 9A, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** and extend into the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** are in direct contact with the wiring layer **126b**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the substrates **122** and the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(118) As shown in FIG. 9B, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **140**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIGS. 9A and 9B, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structures **110** and **120** and the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures **900** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. 9B only shows one of the chip stack structures **900**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(119) Each chip stack structure **900** includes a chip **110a** and a chip structure **120a**, in accordance

with some embodiments. The chip **110a** comes from the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** includes a substrate **112** which comes from the substrate structure **112'**, a portion of the device layer **114**, and a portion of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure **120a** includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer **130**, some of the conductive plugs **140**, and some of the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(120) FIG. **10** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **1000**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **10**, the chip stack structure **1000** is similar to the chip stack structure **900** of FIG. **9B**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **1000** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(121) FIG. **11** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **1100**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **11**, the chip stack structure **1100** is similar to the chip stack structure **900** of FIG. **9B**, except that the chip stack structure **1100** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(122) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(123) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and C are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(124) FIG. **12** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **1200**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **12**, the chip stack structure **1200** is similar to the chip stack structure **1100** of FIG. **11**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **1200** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(125) FIGS. **13A-13B** are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **13A**, after the step of FIG. **1D**, the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layers **116a** and **126a** are partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments.

(126) The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a** and extend into the dielectric layer **116a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH partially expose the wiring layer **116b** of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(127) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer **116a** and the wiring layer **116b** are made of different materials, so there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the dielectric layer **116a** and the wiring layer **116b**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the wiring layer **116b**.

(128) As shown in FIG. **13A**, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** and the dielectric layer **126a** and extend into the dielectric layer **116a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** are in direct contact with the wiring layer **116b**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the substrates **122** and the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(129) As shown in FIG. 13B, conductive bumps 150 are formed over the conductive plugs 140, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIGS. 13A and 13B, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structures 110 and 120 and the insulating layer 130, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures 1300 are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. 13B only shows one of the chip stack structures 1300, in accordance with some embodiments.

(130) Each chip stack structure 1300 includes a chip 110a and a chip structure 120a, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip 110a comes from the semiconductor structure 110, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip 110a includes a substrate 112 which comes from the substrate structure 112', a portion of the device layer 114, and a portion of the interconnect structure 116, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure 120a includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer 130, some of the conductive plugs 140, and some of the conductive bumps 150, in accordance with some embodiments.

(131) FIG. 14 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure 1400, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 14, the chip stack structure 1400 is similar to the chip stack structure 1300 of FIG. 13B, except that the chip structure 120a of the chip stack structure 1400 has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates 112 and 122 are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(132) FIG. 15 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure 1500, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 15, the chip stack structure 1500 is similar to the chip stack structure 1300 of FIG. 13B, except that the chip stack structure 1500 further has a redistribution layer 310 and conductive bumps 320, in accordance with some embodiments.

(133) The redistribution layer 310 is formed over the chip structure 120a, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps 320 are formed over the redistribution layer 310, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer 310 includes a dielectric layer 312, wiring layers 314, and conductive vias 316, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers 314 and conductive vias 316 are in the dielectric layer 312, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias 316 are electrically connected between the wiring layers 314, in accordance with some embodiments.

(134) The conductive plugs 140 and the conductive bumps 320 are electrically connected to the wiring layers 314 and the conductive vias 316, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips 110a and C are electrically connected to the conductive bumps 320 through the conductive plugs 140, the wiring layers 314, and the conductive vias 316, in accordance with some embodiments.

(135) FIG. 16 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure 1600, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 16, the chip stack structure 1600 is similar to the chip stack structure 1500 of FIG. 15, except that the chip structure 120a of the chip stack structure 1600 has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates 112 and 122 are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(136) FIGS. 17A-17D are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 17A, after the step of FIG. 1B, portions of the semiconductor structure 120 are removed to form a trench 128 in the semiconductor structure 120, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench 128 passes through the semiconductor structure 120 and exposes the bonding pads 116p of the interconnect structure 116, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(137) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer 126a and the bonding pads 116p are made of different materials, so there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the dielectric layer 126a and the bonding pads 116p. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the bonding pads 116p.

(138) As shown in FIGS. 1B and 17A, portions of the substrate structure **122'** remain over the interconnect structure **126** after the removal process of the semiconductor structure **120**, in accordance with some embodiments. The portions form substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** continuously surrounds the substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(139) As shown in FIG. 17A, one of the substrates **122**, the device layer **124** remaining under the one of the substrates **122**, and the interconnect structure **126** remaining under the one of the substrates **122** together form a chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnect structure **126** and the substrate **122** thereover have substantially the same width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(140) As shown in FIG. 17B, an insulating layer **130** is formed in the trench **128**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** passes through the semiconductor structure **120**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** is over the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** is in direct contact with the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** continuously surrounds the chips C, in accordance with some embodiments.

(141) As shown in FIGS. 17B and 17C, the insulating layer **130** is partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH partially expose the bonding pads **116p** of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(142) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** and the bonding pads **116p** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the insulating layer **130** and the bonding pads **116p**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the bonding pads **116p**.

(143) As shown in FIG. 17C, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** to the bonding pads **116p** of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the chips C, in accordance with some embodiments. A surface **122a** of the substrate **122**, a surface **132** of the insulating layer **130**, and a surface **142** of the conductive plugs **140** are substantially level with each other, in accordance with some embodiments.

(144) As shown in FIG. 17D, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **140**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 17D, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structure **110** and the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures **1700** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. 17D only shows one of the chip stack structures **1700**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(145) Each chip stack structure **1700** includes a chip **110a** and a chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** comes from the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** includes a substrate **112** which comes from the substrate structure **112'**, a portion of the device layer **114**, and a portion of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure **120a** includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer **130**, some of the conductive plugs **140**, and some of the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(146) FIG. 18 is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **1800**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 18, the chip stack structure **1800** is similar to the chip stack structure **1700** of FIG. 17D, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **1800** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in

size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(147) FIG. **19** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **1900**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **19**, the chip stack structure **1900** is similar to the chip stack structure **1700** of FIG. **17D**, except that the chip stack structure **1900** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(148) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(149) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(150) FIG. **20** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2000**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **20**, the chip stack structure **2000** is similar to the chip stack structure **1900** of FIG. **19**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **2000** has only one chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(151) FIGS. **21A-21D** are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIGS. **1B** and **21A**, after the step of FIG. **1B**, portions of the semiconductor structure **120** are removed to form a trench **128** in the semiconductor structure **120**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** passes through the substrate structure **122'** and extends into the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** exposes the wiring layer **126b** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(152) The surface **126b1** of the wiring layer **126b**, which is exposed by the trench **128**, is lower than a surface **122c** of the substrate **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. The surface **122c** faces the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(153) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The dielectric layer **126a** and the wiring layer **126b** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the dielectric layer **126a** and the wiring layer **126b**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the wiring layer **126b**.

(154) As shown in FIG. **21A**, portions of the substrate structure **122'** remain over the interconnect structure **126** after the removal process of the substrate structure **122'**, in accordance with some embodiments. The portions form substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. The trench **128** continuously surrounds the substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(155) As shown in FIG. **21A**, one of the substrates **122**, the device layer **124** under the one of the substrates **122**, and the interconnect structure **126** under the one of the substrates **122** together form a chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **C** share the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnect structure **126** is wider than each substrate **122**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(156) As shown in FIG. **21B**, an insulating layer **130** is formed in the trench **128**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** extends into the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** is partially in the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** continuously surrounds the

substrates **122** and the device layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(157) As shown in FIGS. **21B** and **21C**, the insulating layer **130** is partially removed to form through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH pass through the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. The through holes TH partially expose the wiring layer **126b** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The removal process includes a photolithography process and an etching process such as a dry etching process, in accordance with some embodiments.

(158) The dry etching process includes a plasma etching process, in accordance with some embodiments. The insulating layer **130** and the wiring layer **126b** are made of different materials, and therefore there is a sufficient etching selectivity between the insulating layer **130** and the wiring layer **126b**. As a result, the dry etching process can stop on the wiring layer **126b**.

(159) As shown in FIG. **21C**, conductive plugs **140** are formed in the through holes TH, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** extends into the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** penetrate through the insulating layer **130** to the wiring layer **126b** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** are partially in the dielectric layer **126a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **140** surround the substrates **122**, in accordance with some embodiments. A width W**140** of the conductive plug **140** decreases toward the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(160) As shown in FIG. **21D**, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **140**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **21D**, a dicing process is performed to cut through the semiconductor structures **110** and **120** and the insulating layer **130**, in accordance with some embodiments. After the dicing process, chip stack structures **2100** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. For the sake of simplicity, FIG. **21D** only shows one of the chip stack structures **2100**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(161) Each chip stack structure **2100** includes a chip **110a** and a chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** comes from the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip **110a** includes a substrate **112** which comes from the substrate structure **112'**, a portion of the device layer **114**, and a portion of the interconnect structure **116**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chip structure **120a** includes the chips C, a portion of insulating layer **130**, some of the conductive plugs **140**, and some of the conductive bumps **150**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(162) FIG. **22** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2200**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **22**, the chip stack structure **2200** is similar to the chip stack structure **2100** of FIG. **21D**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **2200** has only one chip C, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(163) FIG. **23** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2300**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **23**, the chip stack structure **2300** is similar to the chip stack structure **2100** of FIG. **21D**, except that the chip stack structure **2300** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(164) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(165) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips

110a and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. (166) FIG. **24** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2400**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **24**, the chip stack structure **2400** is similar to the chip stack structure **2300** of FIG. **23**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **2400** has only one chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(167) FIGS. **25A-25E** are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a chip stack structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **25A**, after the step of FIG. **17A**, a seed layer **2510** is conformally formed over the chips **C** and the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(168) As shown in FIG. **25A**, a mask layer **2520** is formed over the seed layer **2510**, in accordance with some embodiments. The mask layer **2520** has openings **2522** exposing portions of the seed layer **2510**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **25A**, conductive pillars **2530** are formed in the openings **2522**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(169) As shown in FIG. **25B**, the mask layer **2520** is removed, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **25B**, portions of the seed layer **2510** exposed by the conductive pillars **2530** are removed, in accordance with some embodiments. Each conductive pillar **2530** and the seed layer **2510** thereunder together form a conductive plug **2540**, in accordance with some embodiments. A sidewall **2512** of the seed layer **2510** is substantially aligned with a sidewall **2532** of the conductive pillar **2530** thereover, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **2540** are over and in direct contact with the bonding pads **116p**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(170) As shown in FIG. **25C**, a molding layer **2550** is formed over the chips **C**, the conductive plugs **2540**, and the semiconductor structure **110**, in accordance with some embodiments. The molding layer **2550** is made of a polymer material, in accordance with some embodiments.

(171) As shown in FIG. **25D**, top portions of the conductive plugs **2540**, the molding layer **2550**, and the chips **C** are removed, in accordance with some embodiments. The surfaces **2542**, **2552**, **122a** of the conductive plugs **2540**, the molding layer **2550**, and the substrate **122** of the chip **C** are substantially level with each other, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **25E**, conductive bumps **150** are formed over the conductive plugs **2540**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(172) FIG. **26** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2600**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **26**, the chip stack structure **2600** is similar to the chip stack structure **2500** of FIG. **25E**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **2600** has only one chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(173) FIG. **27** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2700**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **27**, the chip stack structure **2700** is similar to the chip stack structure **2500** of FIG. **25E**, except that the chip stack structure **2700** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(174) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(175) The conductive plugs **140** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips

110a and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **140**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. (176) FIG. **28** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2800**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **28**, the chip stack structure **2800** is similar to the chip stack structure **2700** of FIG. **27**, except that the chip structure **120a** of the chip stack structure **2800** has only one chip **C**, in accordance with some embodiments. The substrates **112** and **122** are similar in size such as width, in accordance with some embodiments.

(177) FIG. **29** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **2900**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **29**, the chip stack structure **2900** is similar to the chip stack structure **2500** of FIG. **25E**, except that the conductive plugs **2540** of the chip stack structure **2900** are connected to the wiring layer **126b'** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **2540** and the molding layer **2550** of the chip stack structure **2900** do not extend into the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(178) FIG. **30** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **3000**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **30**, the chip stack structure **3000** is similar to the chip stack structure **2900** of FIG. **29**, except that the chip stack structure **3000** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(179) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(180) The conductive plugs **2540** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **2540**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(181) FIG. **31** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **3100**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **31**, the chip stack structure **3100** is similar to the chip stack structure **2500** of FIG. **25E**, except that the conductive plugs **2540** of the chip stack structure **3100** are connected to the wiring layer **126b** of the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive plugs **2540** and the molding layer **2550** of the chip stack structure **3100** extend into the interconnect structure **126** and do not penetrate through the interconnect structure **126**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(182) FIG. **32** is a cross-sectional view of a chip stack structure **3200**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. **32**, the chip stack structure **3200** is similar to the chip stack structure **3100** of FIG. **31**, except that the chip stack structure **3200** further has a redistribution layer **310** and conductive bumps **320**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(183) The redistribution layer **310** is formed over the chip structure **120a**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive bumps **320** are formed over the redistribution layer **310**, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution layer **310** includes a dielectric layer **312**, wiring layers **314**, and conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The wiring layers **314** and conductive vias **316** are in the dielectric layer **312**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive vias **316** are electrically connected between the wiring layers **314**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(184) The conductive plugs **2540** and the conductive bumps **320** are electrically connected to the wiring layers **314** and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments. The chips **110a** and **C** are electrically connected to the conductive bumps **320** through the conductive plugs **2540**, the wiring layers **314**, and the conductive vias **316**, in accordance with some embodiments.

(185) Processes and materials for forming the chip stack structures **200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700, 800, 900, 1000, 1100, 1200, 1300, 1400, 1500, 1600, 1700, 1800, 1900, 2000, 2100, 2200, 2300, 2400, 2500, 2600, 2700, 2800, 2900, 3000, 3100, and 3200** may be similar to, or the same as, those for forming the chip stack structure **100** described above. Elements designated by the same reference numbers as those in FIGS. **1A to 32** have structures and materials that are the same or similar. Therefore, the detailed descriptions thereof will not be repeated herein.

(186) The top views of the chip stack structures **100, 500, 900, 1300, 1700, 2100, 2500, 2900, and 3100** are similar to or the same as each other, in accordance with some embodiments.

(187) In contrast with through silicon vias, the conductive plugs **140** (i.e., the through dielectric vias) has a high radius and a low resistance. In addition, the conductive plugs **140** can be formed in the back-end process of all technology nodes without considering chip layouts of different technology nodes. The conductive plugs **140** can land on desired conductive layers or conductive elements to deliver signal/power directly, which improves the signal/power transmission efficiency between the chips of the chip stack structures. The cost of forming the conductive plugs **140** is less than that of forming the through silicon vias, and therefore the conductive plugs **140** can be applied in all technology nodes.

(188) In accordance with some embodiments, chip stack structures and methods for forming the same are provided. The methods (for forming the chip stack structures) include bonding a first semiconductor structure to a second semiconductor structure; partially removing a substrate of the first semiconductor structure to form a trench passing through the substrate; forming an insulating layer in the trench; forming conductive plugs in the trench to electrically connected to the second semiconductor structure; and dicing the first semiconductor structure, the second semiconductor structure, and the insulating layer into chip stack structures. Each chip stack structure includes a first chip coming from the first semiconductor structure and a second chip coming from the second semiconductor structure. The chip stack structure is bonded to a substrate.

(189) Since the conductive plug is directly connected to the second chip without through the first chip, the conductive path between the second chip and the substrate is shortened. Therefore, the resistance of the conductive path is decreased. As a result, the signal integrity and the power integrity between the second chip and the substrate are improved. The method for forming the chip stack structures is adapted to a wafer to wafer process, which improves the signal/power transmission efficiency between the chips of the chip stack structures.

(190) In accordance with some embodiments, a chip stack structure is provided. The chip stack structure includes a first chip including a first substrate and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate. The first interconnect structure includes a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer. The chip stack structure includes a second chip over and bonded to the first chip. The second chip has a second interconnect structure and a second substrate over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure is wider than the second substrate, the second interconnect structure includes a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the first bonding pad is in direct contact with the second bonding pad, and the first dielectric layer is in direct contact with the second dielectric layer. The chip stack structure includes an insulating layer over the second interconnect structure and surrounding the second substrate. The chip stack structure includes a conductive plug penetrating through the insulating layer to the second interconnect structure.

(191) In accordance with some embodiments, a chip stack structure is provided. The chip stack structure includes a first chip including a first substrate and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate. The first interconnect structure includes a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer. The chip stack structure includes a second chip over and bonded to the first chip. The second chip has a second interconnect structure and a second substrate over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure includes a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the first bonding

pad is in direct contact with the second bonding pad, and the first dielectric layer is in direct contact with the second dielectric layer. The chip stack structure includes an insulating layer over the first chip and surrounding the second chip. The chip stack structure includes a conductive plug penetrating through the insulating layer to the first interconnect structure, wherein a first surface of the second substrate, a second surface of the insulating layer, and a third surface of the conductive plug are substantially level with each other.

(192) In accordance with some embodiments, a method for forming a chip stack structure is provided. The method includes providing a first semiconductor structure including a first substrate structure and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate structure. The first interconnect structure includes a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer. The method includes bonding a second semiconductor structure to the first semiconductor structure. The second semiconductor structure includes a second interconnect structure and a second substrate structure over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure includes a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the second bonding pad is bonded to the first bonding pad, and the second dielectric layer is bonded to the first dielectric layer. The method includes partially removing the second substrate structure to form a trench passing through the second substrate structure, wherein a portion of the second substrate structure remains over the second interconnect structure after the partially removing of the second substrate structure, and the trench surrounds the portion. The method includes forming an insulating layer in the trench in the second substrate structure. The method includes forming a conductive plug in the trench. The conductive plug passes through the insulating layer.

(193) The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A chip stack structure, comprising: a first chip comprising a first substrate and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate, wherein the first interconnect structure comprises a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer; a second chip over and bonded to the first chip, wherein the second chip has a second interconnect structure and a second substrate over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure is wider than the second substrate, the second interconnect structure comprises a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the first bonding pad is in direct contact with the second bonding pad, and the first dielectric layer is in direct contact with the second dielectric layer; an insulating layer over the second interconnect structure and surrounding the second substrate; and a conductive plug penetrating through the insulating layer to the second interconnect structure.
2. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein the second interconnect structure comprises a wiring layer embedded in the second dielectric layer, and the conductive plug is in direct contact with the wiring layer.
3. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 2, wherein a first surface of the wiring layer is exposed by the second dielectric layer, and the conductive plug is in direct contact with the first surface of the wiring layer.

4. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 3, wherein the first surface of the wiring layer is substantially level with a second surface of the second dielectric layer under the second substrate.
5. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 3, wherein the insulating layer extends into the second interconnect structure.
6. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 5, wherein the conductive plug extends into the second interconnect structure.
7. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 6, wherein the first surface of the wiring layer is lower than a second surface of the second substrate, and the second surface faces the second interconnect structure.
8. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 2, wherein the conductive plug extends into the second dielectric layer.
9. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first interconnect structure further comprises a third bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer, and the conductive plug further penetrates through the second interconnect structure to the third bonding pad.
10. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first interconnect structure further comprises a wiring layer in the first dielectric layer, and the conductive plug further penetrates through the second interconnect structure and extends into the first dielectric layer to be connected to the wiring layer.
11. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein a width of the conductive plug decreases toward the first chip.
12. A chip stack structure, comprising: a first chip comprising a first substrate and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate, wherein the first interconnect structure comprises a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer; a second chip over and bonded to the first chip, wherein the second chip has a second interconnect structure and a second substrate over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure comprises a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the first bonding pad is in direct contact with the second bonding pad, and the first dielectric layer is in direct contact with the second dielectric layer; an insulating layer over the first chip and surrounding the second chip; and a conductive plug penetrating through the insulating layer to the first interconnect structure, wherein a first surface of the second substrate, a second surface of the insulating layer, and a third surface of the conductive plug are substantially level with each other.
13. The chip stack structure as claimed in claim 12, wherein the conductive plug comprises a seed layer and a conductive pillar over the seed layer, and a first sidewall of the seed layer is substantially aligned with a second sidewall of the conductive pillar.
14. A method for forming a chip stack structure, comprising: providing a first semiconductor structure comprising a first substrate structure and a first interconnect structure over the first substrate structure, wherein the first interconnect structure comprises a first dielectric layer and a first bonding pad embedded in the first dielectric layer; bonding a second semiconductor structure to the first semiconductor structure, wherein the second semiconductor structure comprises a second interconnect structure and a second substrate structure over the second interconnect structure, the second interconnect structure comprises a second dielectric layer and a second bonding pad embedded in the second dielectric layer, the second bonding pad is bonded to the first bonding pad, and the second dielectric layer is bonded to the first dielectric layer; partially removing the second substrate structure to form a trench passing through the second substrate structure, wherein a portion of the second substrate structure remains over the second interconnect structure after the partially removing of the second substrate structure, and the trench surrounds the portion; forming an insulating layer in the trench in the second substrate structure; and forming a conductive plug in the trench, wherein the conductive plug passes through the insulating layer.
15. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 14, wherein the second interconnect structure comprises a wiring layer embedded in the second dielectric layer, a surface

of the wiring layer is exposed by the trench, and the conductive plug is in direct contact with the surface of the wiring layer.

16. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 15, wherein the partially removing of the second substrate structure further comprises: partially removing the second dielectric layer, wherein the trench extends into the second dielectric layer, and the insulating layer and the conductive plug are partially in the second dielectric layer.

17. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 14, wherein the forming of the conductive plug in the trench comprises: partially removing the insulating layer and the second dielectric layer to form a through hole passing through the insulating layer and extending into the second dielectric layer and partially exposing a wiring layer of the second interconnect structure; and forming the conductive plug in the through hole.

18. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 14, wherein the forming of the conductive plug in the trench comprises: partially removing the insulating layer and the second dielectric layer to form a through hole passing through the insulating layer and the second dielectric layer and partially exposing a third bonding pad of the first interconnect structure; and forming the conductive plug in the through hole.

19. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 14, wherein the forming of the conductive plug in the trench comprises: partially removing the insulating layer, the second dielectric layer, and the first dielectric layer to form a through hole passing through the insulating layer and the second dielectric layer and extending into the first dielectric layer and partially exposing a wiring layer of the first interconnect structure; and forming the conductive plug in the through hole.

20. The method for forming the chip stack structure as claimed in claim 14, wherein the forming of the insulating layer in the trench in the second substrate structure and the forming of the conductive plug in the trench comprise: forming the conductive plug in the trench; and after forming the conductive plug in the trench, forming the insulating layer in the trench in the second substrate structure.
